

Cybercrime Case Study: UPI/Online Payment Fraud

UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud is a common cybercrime in India where attackers trick users into transferring money by exploiting their lack of awareness. This type of fraud is increasing rapidly due to the widespread use of digital payment apps like Google Pay, PhonePe, and Paytm.

In a typical case, the attacker contacts the victim through a phone call, SMS, or social media message pretending to be a bank official, customer support agent, or buyer. The attacker may send a fake payment request or QR code and claim that scanning it will help the victim receive money. When the victim follows the instructions, they are asked to enter their UPI PIN to complete the transaction. However, instead of receiving money, the victim unknowingly sends money to the attacker.

This fraud mainly targets students, elderly people, and individuals who are new to digital payments. The consequences include financial loss, emotional stress, and in some cases, misuse of personal information.

This case highlights the importance of digital awareness. Users must understand that UPI PIN is only required to send money, not to receive it. Being cautious while handling unknown requests can prevent such cybercrimes.